08-05 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文） Why Do We Dream at Night?

① Last night, you may have travelled back to your old primary school, flown above a city without a plane, or had a long conversation with a grandmother who is no longer alive. In the morning, most of it was gone before you finished brushing your teeth. Dreams are strange: they feel real in the night and unreal in the day. Almost every human being dreams, yet we still cannot fully answer a simple question — **why do we dream?** Modern research in biology and psychology can now offer some careful, if partial, answers.

② First, we need to know **when** dreams happen. Sleep is not a single state; it moves in circles. Each night we go through 4 or 5 "sleep cycles", and each cycle lasts about 90 minutes. Inside a cycle, we fall first into deep sleep, and later into a stage called **REM sleep**. "REM" means "rapid eye movement": our eyelids are closed, but underneath, the eyes move quickly from side to side, and brain activity becomes almost as strong as when we are awake. **Most of our vivid dreams happen in REM sleep.** This is why, if you wake up in the last part of the night (when REM sleep is longest), you are more likely to remember your dreams.

③ Curiously, during REM sleep, the muscles of our arms and legs are almost completely turned off. Scientists believe this is a kind of **safety system**. If the body could still move, we might get up and run around while dreaming, which could be dangerous. The brain's night theatre is open, but the doors of the body are quietly locked.

④ The second question is **why the brain creates dreams at all**. There is no single answer, but three theories are widely discussed.

⑤ One theory is that dreams are **a way to sort and save memories**. During the day, we take in a huge amount of information: names, faces, words, smells, the rule of a maths question. While we sleep, the brain seems to review these pieces, mark what is important, and gently let go of what is not. In many experiments, people who slept after learning something scored better on a test than those who stayed awake. Dreams may be what this sorting looks like "from the inside".

⑥ A second theory is that dreams are **a kind of emotional repair**. Our days are full of small worries — a quarrel with a friend, a difficult question in class, a scary news story. In dreams, the brain may replay these feelings but in a safer, stranger form. Some researchers even say the brain turns down certain "fear chemicals" during REM sleep, so that we can face these feelings without panic. When morning comes, the emotion has often softened.

⑦ A third theory treats dreams as **mental rehearsal**. In some dreams, we are running from danger, solving a problem, or trying to reach a goal. These scenes may be our ancient brain "practising" — rehearsing how to deal with difficulties we might meet in real life. This is why, after a hard day of sport or study, dreams often carry pictures of the same activity.

⑧ We should also correct a few common ideas. It is **not true** that "only clever people dream", or that "dreams always predict the future". Every healthy human dreams every night, whether or not they remember. And while some dreams may feel like signs, most of the time they are **echoes of the past day**, not messages from tomorrow. If a dream gives you a fresh idea or warm feeling in the morning, enjoy it; if it frightens you, remember it is just your brain's night work.

⑨ We still cannot fully explain every dream. Why a teapot becomes a dragon; why your best friend turns into a stranger; why a dream repeats for months — these remain partly mysterious. But the direction is clear: dreams are not "nothing", and they are not magic. They are one of the many quiet ways the sleeping brain takes care of us, sorting our memories, calming our feelings, and preparing us, gently, for a new day.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. When during the night do most vivid dreams happen?

A. During deep sleep, right after falling asleep.
B. During REM sleep, when the eyes move quickly under closed lids.
C. Only during the last minute before waking up.
D. Only in the first sleep cycle of the night.

2. Why are the muscles of our arms and legs almost turned off during REM sleep?

A. Because the muscles get tired and fall asleep first.
B. Because it is a safety system, so that we do not run around while dreaming.
C. Because dreams make the muscles grow.
D. Because the blood cannot reach them at night.

3. Which of the following is NOT one of the three theories in the passage about why we dream?

A. Dreams help the brain sort and save memories.
B. Dreams are a kind of emotional repair.
C. Dreams are a mental rehearsal for real-life challenges.
D. Dreams are messages sent by spirits from another world.

4. Which statement about dreams is correct according to the passage?

A. Only clever people have dreams.
B. Dreams always correctly predict the future.
C. Every healthy person dreams every night, even if they do not remember.
D. People who remember dreams are sick.

5. What is the main purpose of this passage?

A. To frighten readers about nightmares.
B. To explain, with scientific ideas, when and why humans dream, and to correct common wrong beliefs about dreams.
C. To sell a kind of "dream medicine".
D. To teach readers how to avoid sleeping.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段
【解析】REM 期眼球快速移动时梦境最生动。A/C/D 错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段
【解析】保护机制，防止在梦中乱跑。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题（选非）
【定位】第⑤⑥⑦段
【解析】文中提出三种：记忆整理、情绪修复、心理演练；不涉及"灵魂传信"。故选 D。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段
【解析】每个健康人每晚都做梦，只是未必记得。A/B/D 均属被否定说法。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】全文
【解析】科普式解释梦的时机与原因并纠正误解。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **REM sleep**（*Rapid Eye Movement sleep*）[n.] 快速眼动睡眠